President Franklin D. Roosevelt and was a respected and prestigious liberal organization that had attracted some of the best-known names in Hollywood.

Like a number of other groups I had joined, it was pledged to fighting fascism and safeguarding our national freedoms, and I was greatly honored by the invitation to be on its board of directors and looked forward to my first meeting.

There were about sixty board members at the meeting, many of whom I didn't recognize, particularly the members of the executive committee, who were seated at a table facing the board members.

As the meeting got under way, I became slightly annoyed at how it was conducted: An item of business would come up for discussion and one of the officers would say, "Well, there's no need to take this up with the entire board. The executive committee can take care of it." It also bothered me when FDR's son, Jimmy Roosevelt, whom I knew, came under brutal personal attack from a couple of well-known Hollywood writers after he said groups such as ours needed to be vigilant against being used by Communist sympathizers.

Dore Schary, the head of MGM, was sitting next to me and I nudged him and said: "Where are all the people that used to be here, the heads of the other studios and so forth?"

He looked at me and then leaned over and whispered: "Stop by Olivia de Havilland's apartment after the meeting."

Olivia was a member of the executive committee of HICCASP. Ten of us met later that night at her apartment and I was amazed when she and others in the room said they suspected Communists were trying to take over the organization. As we talked over the situation, I turned to her and whispered: "You know, Olivia, I always thought *you* might be one of 'them.'"

She laughed and said, "That's funny. I thought *you* were one of them."